

Activity: Get help in the command line

Scenario

In this scenario, you have to find more information about commands that you need to use. You also need to discover which command to use to perform a certain task.

Task 1. Learn more about commands

In this task, you need to explore a few commands you can use in the shell to learn more about the functionality of other commands.

First, imagine you can't quite remember what the cat command does and want a quick reminder.

1. Run the `whatis` command to get a short description of `cat`.
2. Use the `man` command to get more details about `cat`

```
analyst@0826d74e889a:~$ whatis cat
cat (1) - concatenate files and print on the standard output
analyst@0826d74e889a:~$ man cat
CAT(1) User Commands CAT(1)

NAME
    cat - concatenate files and print on the standard output

SYNOPSIS
    cat [OPTION]... [FILE]...

DESCRIPTION
    Concatenate FILE(s) to standard output.

    With no FILE, or when FILE is -, read standard input.

    -A, --show-all
        equivalent to -vET

    -b, --number-nonblank
        number nonempty output lines, overrides -n

    -e
        equivalent to -vE

    -E, --show-ends
        display $ at end of each line

    -n, --number
        number all output lines

    -s, --squeeze-blank
```

What are the first two words of the short description of cat returned by whatis?

☒ file concatenator

☒ concatenate files

☐ cat is

☐ the cat

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What option can you use to number the output lines of the cat command?

☒ -n, --number

☐ none - it is the default option

☒ -b, --number nonblank

☐ -e, --enumerate

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3. Press **Q** to exit this manual page.

4. Use `apropos` to find a command that returns the first part of a file:

`apropos -a first part file`

```
analyst@0826d74e889a:~$ apropos -a first part file
head (1) - output the first part of files
analyst@0826d74e889a:~$
```

Which command returns the first part of a file?

☐ tail

☐ list

☐ cat

☒ head

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Task 2. Explore the useradd command

In this task, imagine that you want to set the expiration date for a temporary user account. You know that you need to use the `useradd` command for this, but you're not quite sure how to complete the task. You realize it might involve adding an option to the command.

1. Use the most appropriate Linux command to get help on the `useradd` command and learn more about all of its options.

```
The new user will be created using HOME_DIR as the value for the
user's login directory. The default is to append the LOGIN name to
BASE_DIR and use that as the login directory name. If the
directory HOME_DIR does not exist, then it will be created unless
the -M option is specified.
```

```
-D, --defaults
```

```
See below, the subsection "Changing the default values".
```

```
-e, --expiredate EXPIRE_DATE
```

```
The date on which the user account will be disabled. The date is
specified in the format YYYY-MM-DD.
```

```
If not specified, useradd will use the default expiry date
specified by the EXPIRE variable in /etc/default/useradd, or an
empty string (no expiry) by default.
```

```
-f, --inactive INACTIVE
```

```
defines the number of days after the password exceeded its maximum
age where the user is expected to replace this password. The value
is stored in the shadow password file. An input of 0 will disable
an expired password with no delay. An input of -1 will blank the
respective field in the shadow password file. See shadow(5) for
more information.
```

Use *man useradd*

Which option can be used with the `useradd` command to set an expiration date for a temporary user account?

☒ -e

☐ -d

☐ -x

☐ -f

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Task 3. Explore the `rm` and `rmdir` commands

In this task, you need to determine the difference between the `rm` and `rmdir` commands.

Imagine that you've used these commands before, but you can't remember how they're different.

Use the most appropriate Linux command to quickly remind yourself what each command does.

Note: This task will require entering two commands, one with `rm` and one with `rmdir`.

```
analyst@0826d74e889a:~$ whatis rmdir
rmdir (1)          - remove empty directories
rmdir (2)          - delete a directory
analyst@0826d74e889a:~$ whatis rm
rm (1)             - remove files or directories
analyst@0826d74e889a:~$
```



Which of these commands removes only empty directories?

 ☒ rmdir

☐ rm

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Task 4. Determine which command to use

In this task, imagine that you need to create a new group but you can't remember what command to use. You need to identify a command that will do this by searching for it through keywords. In this case, use the keywords `create new group`.

- Use the most appropriate Linux command with these keywords to identify what command to use.

```
analyst@0826d74e889a:~$ apropos -a create new group
groupadd (8)          - create a new group
analyst@0826d74e889a:~$
```



What command can you use to create a new group?

 ☒ groupadd

☐ newgroup

☐ setsid

☐ addnewgroup

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